



Acacia

Ouch! These thorns are super-sharp and as long as a banana. They protect the leaves of the acacia (uh-kay-shuh) tree from hungry animals. Giraffes have such a long tongue that they can reach around the spines. However, some acacia trees have another defence. Their thorns have a fat base, which is home to biting ants. Any animal that tries to eat the tree is faced with the angry ants!

Acacia trees have one more secret weapon. They talk to each other! If one of them comes under attack, it releases a chemical into the air to warn trees nearby. Then, they quickly pump their leaves full of a bitter-flavoured chemical, which tastes so nasty they are left alone.

